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Culture (OWC): [Shona \(FS05\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1967-1972

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Place Coverage: Northeastern Zimbabwe

Section Title(S): ABUSE (KUNYOMBA) • LYING (KUNYEPA)

It is incorrect for a man to refuse to share his beer with others. If he does, then visits them afterwards, he is blamed for his omission. The act of refusing beer to another person can be taken as a motive for abuse (*kunyomba*).

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Alcoholic Beverages

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Interpersonal Relations

It is considered regrettable for a man to abuse his wife for the misconduct of their son or daughter, making her the scapegoat. She, of course, knows better than to answer him back in anger. She contains herself until his anger is spent and then seeks the reason for all his false accusations. Normally, abusing people is considered bad unless it is a parent chastising his child as a corrective.

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Interpersonal Relations

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Family Relationships

Scolding (*kutukana*), is a serious offence and every boy and girl is warned against employing cruel insulting words against anyone. Quarrels follow any malreference to a person's background. Scolding words and insults are often heard at beer drinks. Women too, resort to strong language when they quarrel, as for instance when one borrows a pot from another and does not return it. When quarrels follow scolding, it is usual for the matter to be settled by the village head, but if he fails, the matter is taken to the chief at his court.

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Ingroup Antagonisms

Two varieties of scolding (*kutuka*) are known. The first takes the form of a joke and is permitted only among ritual friends (*vasahwira*) who allow derogatory things to be said by each other without their causing annoyance. Any other form of scolding is considered bad, especially the use of words

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Interpersonal Relations

LYING (KUNYEPA)

The word *manyepo* (lies) has as its verb *kunyepa*. Some lies are libellous, others fraud of one kind or another. If 85 lies are unintentional and do not hurt another person it is not as bad as when someone suffers from them, and the lies are then spoken of as malicious gossip (*makuhwa*) or deceit (*unyengedzi*). A person who has promised a gift but fails to produce it or has failed to carry out what he has promised to do is telling a straight lie. By keeping company with a liar a person is also assumed to possess this bad quality. Further, if one member of a family is a liar, the rest of its members run the risk of being so labelled. A person who is known to others as a liar is not trusted and people try to avoid him. When he comes up to others they immediately stop talking or change the subject, showing that they do not trust him.

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